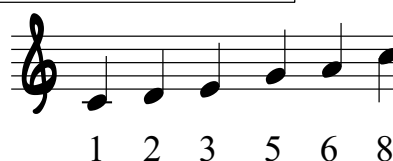


COLTRANE MINOR PENTATONIC

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #199

A pentatonic scale is just what it sounds like, *any* five note scale. The "Major Pentatonic Scale" and the "Minor Pentatonic Scale" (see below) got in on the action early, hired a good publicist, and they are now what most of us now think of as THE pentatonic scales. But not so fast. There are so many more pentatonic scales, with amazing sounds, from many cultures around the world. Here, we'll look at a "different minor pentatonic," sometimes called the "Coltrane Minor Penatonic," or the "Minor 7 (b5) Pentatonic" (according to Jerry Bergonzi).

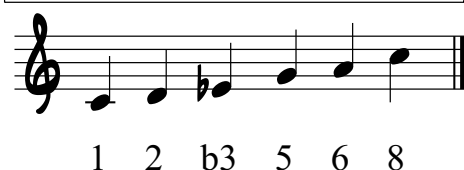
#1 - Major Pent.



#2 - Minor Pent.



#3 - Coltrane Minor Pent.



The real power of pentatonics is realized when we begin using simple patterns with the scale. Below is a pattern that could be described as "skip up two notes" (C to Eb), "step up one note" (Eb to G), and "skip down two notes" (G to D). A good visual is "hop up two stairs, hop up one more, then hop down two stairs." Go up one stair, and do it all again.

#4 - Melodic pattern with C minor pentatonic



Notice all the intervals of a 4th that this pattern gives us. They give this melody a great modern, angular sound.

#5 - Using the pattern over a C minor tonality



Of course, this C minor pentatonic scale works nicely over any Cm chord. Cm7, Cm6/9, Cm9, Cm11, etc.

#6 - Using the C scale over a B7 tonality



The amazing thing is the *many* different tonalities where we can use this C minor scale. A07, F7, B7alt, Ebmaj7, etc.